ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE Z
REAL PROPERTY TRANSFER TAX

VOTE NO on Measure Z ! Protect Benicia's future!

Benicia voters **rejected** a transfer tax increase in 2024 — by more than an 18% margin. The message was unmistakable. But City Hall didn't listen. They're back again, pushing the same tax increase under a new label.

Now City Hall is spending $288,000 of your tax dollars on consultants and marketing to sell these Measures. Added to the $233,000 spent promoting the 2024 failed measures, that's over **half a million dollars** that could have gone to community needs.

The City's latest gimmick: a supposed "exemption" for homes up to $2 million. Benicia has a long history of raising tax rates. Once Measure Z passes, City Hall can seek to reduce or eliminate that exemption. As one Councilmember admitted: **"this way it'll be easier to sell."**

Entrance tax now. Exit tax later. Newer homes, apartment buildings, and commercial properties get no exemption. Inflation guarantees more and more homes will be pushed over the threshold. That includes your home. Measure Z is designed to grow — not stay "limited."

The City admits Measure Z would raise $230,000 a year — less than 1/2% of Benicia's $119 million budget. **A rounding error**. Measure Z won't fix the City's finances — but it will hit homeowners and businesses hard.

Measure Z is an entrance and an exit tax — it will fall hardest on retirees who need to downsize. The coming "Silver Tsunami" is real.

Measure Z is **not** needed for new construction. Measure Z is a GENERAL FUND TAX. The City may spend it on anything — not just infrastructure.

Benicia families already face sky high tax rates. City Hall wants to add a transfer tax that will make it harder for your children and grandchildren to buy or sell a home in Benicia.

Vote No on Measure Z !

Association of Benicians Opposing Charter City and Real Property Transfer Tax Measures
s/ Christopher Shenfield, Attorney at Law and Chairperson
s/ Lawrence Morsen, Retired Water Utility Executive
s/ Kenneth Bocox, 40-Year Benicia Resident
s/ William J. Groves, Retired Title Insurance Executive
s/ Melinda A. Laudy, Principal Interior Designer

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